

Emily Stokes

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Research Interests

Art history postgraduate focused on East German memory, surveillance, and identity politics, with an emphasis on visual culture and archival practice.

Education

PhD History of Art (2025 - 2022)

The University of Birmingham, Birmingham

Thesis: Murmurs of Affect, Queer Sexuality, and (Extra-)Archival Practice in the German Democratic Republic, 1979-1990 (passed without corrections)

Committee: Dr. G. Salter, Prof. Dr. J. Evans, (Chair: Dr. E. L'Estrange)

Supervision: Dr. C. Smith, Prof. Dr. S. Jones

M.A. History of Art (2021 - 2020)

The Courtauld Institute, London

Thesis: Those who do not move do not feel their chains: Surveillance, Identity, and Paranoia in the German Democratic Republic

Graduated with Distinction

B.A. History of Art (2020 - 2017)

The University of Nottingham, Nottingham

Graduated First Class

Work Experience

Doctoral Placement, Bert Hardy Collection (2024 -2025)

The Victoria & Albert Museum, London

Office & Saleroom Administrator (2022 - 2018)

Mellors & Kirk Fine Art Auctioneers, Nottingham

Internship (Summer 2021)

Stephen Friedman Gallery, London

Publications

Stokes, E. (2025). From exotic 'other' to violent sex: positionalities and perspectives of (East) Germany and Eastern Europe in gay porn after 1990. *Porn Studies*, 1-20. doi.org/10.1080/23268743.2025.2503879. (OA)

Stokes, E. (forthcoming) 'Meinen namenlosen Tramper': The Inbetweenness of East German Film-maker Gino Hahnemann (1946-2006). *German Life & Letters*.

Stokes, E. (under review) The Unexpected Death: Perspectives on a Death Dive in the V&A's Collection.

Stokes, E. (forthcoming) *Murmurs of Affect, Queer Sexuality, and (Extra-)Archival Practice in the German Democratic Republic, 1979-1990*. *Peter Lang Verlag*.
(Winner of the Emerging Scholars Competition in Queer Studies – German Studies; Gold Open Access / OAPEN).

Conference Presentations

October 2025	‘Queer Image Makers and Keepers: Collaboration, Affect, and Archivisation in the Stasi Records Archive’, SECAC annual conference, Cincinnati OH.
June 2025	‘The Stage and Costume Designs of Peter Kothe: Slipping Between Life and Theatre in the GDR’, Light On! Queer Literatures and Cultures under Socialism, Universität Regensburg.
May 2025	From Revolution to Manhood: Masculinity under Socialism, self-organised, University of Birmingham.
June 2024	‘From Exotic Other to Violent Sex: Positionalities and Perspectives of East Germany in Gay Porn After 1990’, The GDR Today VII, University of Liverpool.
March 2024	‘From Exotic Other to Violent Sex: Positionalities and Perspectives of East Germany in Gay Porn After 1990’, Research Forum for German Visual Culture (online), University of Edinburgh.
July 2023	‘Watching the Boys: Surveillance, Subjectivity, and Queer Visual Culture in the GDR, 1979-1990’, Knowledge and Narratives of East Germany Before and After 1989, University of Cambridge.

Teaching Experience

Spring 2025	Objects and Medium, Department of Art History, Curating and Visual Studies, The University of Birmingham.
Spring 2025	Research Techniques in History of Art, Department of Art History, Curating and Visual Studies, The University of Birmingham.
Spring 2025	Debates and Methods in the History of Art, Department of Art History, Curating and Visual Studies, The University of Birmingham.
Autumn 2024	Historical Concepts in the History of Art, Department of Art History, Curating and Visual Studies, The University of Birmingham.

Grants, Scholarships, & Awards

2025	Gulnar Bosch Travel Awards, SECAC
2024	Research and Travel Grant, Association for German Studies
2024	Research Grant, Women+ in German Studies
2025 – 2022	Wolfson Postgraduate Scholarship

2020	Undergraduate Dissertation Prize, Shortlisted, Association for Art History
2020	Best Dissertation, Best Academic Performance, and Best Overall Mark, The University of Nottingham

Service to the Profession

since 2026	Porn Studies Journal Reviewer
since 2025	Equity, Diversity, and Inclusion Representative Women+ in German Studies

References

Camilla Smith	Senior Lecturer & Head of Department of Art History, Curating and Visual Studies The University of Birmingham, United Kingdom h.c.smith@bham.ac.uk
Sara Jones	Professor of Languages, Cultures and Societies The University of Birmingham, United Kingdom s.jones1@bham.ac.uk
Martin Barnes	Senior Curator of Photography The Victoria & Albert Museum, London, United Kingdom m.barnes@vam.ac.uk